$21.55 billion in 2016–17; $17.91 billion in 2015–16; $61.41 billion in 2014–15; and $15.51 billion in 2013–14.

FDI Flows Exceeded $700 Billion in Twenty Years

India started compiling FDI data systematically and consistently from the year 2000. FDI data has three components: equity inflows, reinvested earnings and other capital. FDI is primarily equity flows from the rest of the world to India. Such equity flows are primarily in companies and other incorporated bodies. However, small FDI flows are also received by unincorporated bodies like partnerships and individual proprietorship concerns. FDI equity inflow data is available for incorporated and unincorporated bodies separately. The profits earned on the foreign equity investment already in the country and not repatriated abroad are counted as reinvested equity earning. Some inflows with quasi-equity characteristics, such as foreign currency convertible bonds, are accounted for as ‘other capital’.

India has received total FDI of $721.78 billion until September 2020. Of this, $502.88 billion was new equity inflows in incorporated bodies and $18 billion in unincorporated bodies, bringing the new equity FDI inflow total to $520.88 billion. Reinvested earnings amounted to $161.71 billion while other capital inflows were $39.19 billion.

DPIIT, in the Ministry of Industry and Commerce, maintains detailed data, such as countries of origin of FDI, sectors in which FDI is flowing and states where FDI landed. As per this comprehensive database, which is published every quarter, pure equity inflows until September 2020 stood at $500.12 billion (as against $520.88 billion, according to RBI data).

Fifty per cent of these pure equity inflows of $500.12 billion have come from two countries: Mauritius ($144.71 billion; 28.94 per cent) and Singapore ($105.97; 21.19 per cent). The US, the Netherlands, the UK and Japan are other significant exporters of FDI to India, contributing more than